

Word family: **date / dates / dated / dating / predate / postdate / undated / outdated / up-to-date**

Base word: date

Part of speech: **noun** and **verb**

Related forms:

- * **date** (n.) — 日期；年代；約會；約會對象；椰棗
- * **date** (v.) — 註明日期；確定年代；追溯；與某人約會
- * **dated** (adj.) — 過時的；有年代感的
- * **dating** (n.) — 約會；年代測定
- * **predate** (v.) — 早於；在.....之前已存在
- * **postdate** (v.) — 晚於；把日期寫成未來日期
- * **undated** (adj.) — 沒有註明日期的
- * **outdated** (adj.) — 過時的；不再適用的
- * **up-to-date** (adj.) — 最新的；掌握最新情況的

Useful compounds / fixed expressions:

- * **today's date**
- * **date of birth**
- * **date of issue**
- * **effective date**
- * **closing date**
- * **expiry date**
- * **best-before / use-by date**
- * **set / fix / name a date**
- * **at a later date**
- * **to date**
- * **up to date**
- * **out of date**
- * **save the date**
- * **date back to / date from**
- * **go on a date**
- * **have a date**
- * **your date**
- * **blind date**
- * **double date**
- * **date night**
- * **speed dating**
- * **carbon dating**
- * **date palm**
- * **dried dates**
- * **pitted dates**
- * **date syrup**
- * **date paste**

Meaning in this passage

> He never treated it as a dry subject full of names and **dates**.

Here, **dates** means:

specific historical days, months, or especially years connected with events — 日期；年份

In this context, **names and dates** represents the stereotype of history as factual memorisation.

中文翻譯：

他從不把歷史當成一門只有人名和**年份 / 日期**的枯燥科目。

In this particular passage, **「年份」** is especially natural because history classes often require students to remember years such as 1914, 1945, etc.

1. **date (日期) — 日期**

This is the core meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> He never treated history as a dry subject full of names and **dates**.

他從不把歷史當成一門只有人名和**年份 / 日期**的枯燥科目。

Practice 2

> Do you remember the **date** of the battle?

你記得那場戰役的**日期**嗎？

Practice 3

> Please write the **date** at the top of the page.

請在頁面上方寫上**日期**。

MCQ-ready definition:

date = 用日、月、年等表示某件事發生或安排在甚麼時間

2. **historical date — 歷史日期；年份**

Practice 1

> Students had to memorize important **historical dates**.

學生要背誦重要的**歷史年份**。

Practice 2

> 1945 is an important **date** in modern history.

1945 年是現代史上一個重要的**年份**。

MCQ-ready definition:

historical date = 與重要歷史事件相關的年份或具體日期

3. **today's date — 今天的日期**

Practice 1

> What's **today's date**?

今天是**幾月幾日**？

Practice 2

> Write **today's date** on the form.

在表格上寫上**今天的日期**。

MCQ-ready definition:

today's date = 當天的具體日、月、年

4. **date of birth — 出生日期**

Practice 1

> Please enter your **date of birth**.

請填寫你的**出生日期**。

Practice 2

> His **date of birth** is printed on the document.

文件上印有他的**出生日期**。

MCQ-ready definition:

date of birth = 某人出生的具體日期

5. **date of issue — 簽發日期**

Practice 1

> Check the **date of issue** on your passport.

查看護照上的**簽發日期**。

Practice 2

> The certificate shows the **date of issue**.

證書上列有**簽發日期**。

MCQ-ready definition:

date of issue = 文件、證件或物品正式簽發的日期

6. **effective date — 生效日期**

Practice 1

> The policy's **effective date** is 1 January.

這項政策的**生效日期**是 1 月 1 日。

Practice 2

> The contract states the **effective date** clearly.

合約清楚列明**生效日期**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****effective date = 規則、合約或制度正式開始生效的日期****

7. ****closing / deadline date — 截止日期****

Practice 1

> The ****closing date**** for applications is Friday.

申請的****截止日期****是星期五。

Practice 2

> Make sure you submit it before the ****deadline date****.

確保在****截止日期****前提交。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****closing/deadline date = 某項申請、活動或工作必須完成前的最後日期****

8. ****expiry date — 到期日；有效期****

Practice 1

> Check the ****expiry date**** before using the medicine.

用藥前先查看****有效期 / 到期日****。

Practice 2

> My passport's ****expiry date**** is next month.

我的護照下個月****到期****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****expiry date = 某物停止有效、不能再使用的日期****

9. ****best-before / use-by date — 最佳食用日期 / 食用期限****

Practice 1

> Check the **best-before date** on the package.

查看包裝上的**最佳食用日期**。

Practice 2

> Do not eat it after the **use-by date**.

過了**食用期限**就不要再吃。

MCQ-ready definition:

best-before/use-by date = 食品品質最佳或安全食用期限所標示的日期

10. **set / fix / name a date** — 定下日期

Practice 1

> We haven't **set a date** for the meeting.

我們還未**定下會議日期**。

Practice 2

> They finally **fixed a date** for the wedding.

他們終於**定下婚禮日期**。

MCQ-ready definition:

set/fix/name a date = 選定並明確指定某件事進行的日期

11. **at a later date** — 日後；稍後

Practice 1

> We can discuss that **at a later date**.

我們可以**日後再談**這件事。

Practice 2

> More details will be announced ****at a later date****.

更多詳情會在****稍後日期****公布。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****at a later date = 在未來某個較後時間****

12. ****to date — 到目前為止****

Practice 1

> This is his best performance ****to date****.

這是他****到目前為止****最好的表現。

Practice 2

> No problems have been reported ****to date****.

****截至目前為止****，尚未有問題被報告。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****to date = 從過去一直到現在為止****

13. ****up to date — 最新的；掌握最新情況的****

Practice 1

> The information is completely ****up to date****.

這些資料完全是****最新的****。

Practice 2

> I try to keep ****up to date**** with current research.

我盡量****跟上最新研究進展****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****up to date = 已包括最新資訊或發展；沒有落後於目前情況****

14. ****out of date — 過時的；過期的****

Practice 1

> This information is ****out of date****.

這些資料已經****過時****。

Practice 2

> This document is now ****out of date****.

這份文件現在已經****不再有效 / 過時****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****out of date = 不再符合目前情況，或已超過有效期限****

15. ****save the date — 預留日期****

A very common modern fixed expression.

Practice 1

> ****Save the date****—the wedding is on 12 June.

****請預留這一天****——婚禮在 6 月 12 日舉行。

Practice 2

> We sent everyone a ****save-the-date**** card.

我們向所有人寄出了****預留日期通知卡****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****save the date = 請對方把某個日期預留出來，不要安排其他事情****

16. ****date (年代；時期) — 年代；時期****

Practice 1

> The exact ****date**** of the building is uncertain.

這座建築的確切**年代**不詳。

Practice 2

> The object appears to be of a much earlier **date**.

這件物品似乎屬於更早的**年代**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****date = 某件物品、作品或事件所屬的歷史時間****

17. **date something (註明日期) — 在.....寫上日期**

Practice 1

> Please **date the letter** before sending it.

寄信前請先在信上**寫上日期**。

Practice 2

> The document was **dated 15 May**.

文件上**註明日期為 5 月 15 日**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****date something = 在文件、信件等上寫明日期****

18. **date something (確定年代) — 判定.....的年代**

Practice 1

> Experts **dated the painting** to the seventeenth century.

專家判定這幅畫**屬於十七世紀**。

Practice 2

> Scientists are trying to **date the bones**.

科學家正嘗試**確定這些骨骼的年代**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****date something = 判斷某件物品、遺骸或遺址來自哪個時期****

19. ****dating (年代測定) — 年代測定****

This was one of the meanings that should have been explicitly included.

Practice 1

> Scientists used several methods of ****dating**** the site.

科學家使用多種方法為遺址進行****年代測定****。

Practice 2

> Accurate ****dating**** of the remains is difficult.

準確判定這些遺骸的****年代****很困難。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****dating = 確定物品、遺骸、岩石或遺址年代的過程****

20. ****carbon dating — 碳年代測定****

Practice 1

> Scientists used ****carbon dating**** to estimate the age of the object.

科學家使用****碳年代測定法****估計物件的年代。

Practice 2

> ****Carbon dating**** showed that the remains were thousands of years old.

****碳年代測定****顯示這些遺骸已有數千年歷史。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****carbon dating = 利用放射性碳來估算有機物年代的方法****

21. **date from / date back to — 始於；追溯至**

Practice 1

> The building **dates from** the nineteenth century.

這座建築**始建於十九世紀**。

Practice 2

> The tradition **dates back to** ancient times.

這項傳統可**追溯至古代**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****date from/back to X = 起源於、建立於或已存在自某個較早年代****

22. **predate — 早於；在……之前已存在**

A useful family member that was missing before.

Practice 1

> This temple **predates** the railway.

這座寺廟的歷史**早於**鐵路。

Practice 2

> The tradition **predates** modern technology.

這項傳統在現代科技出現以前**已經存在**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****predate = 在時間上早於另一件事物****

23. **postdate (時間上晚於) — 晚於；在……之後出現**

Practice 1

> The document **postdates** the war.

這份文件的年代**晚於那場戰爭**。

Practice 2

> The building clearly **postdates** the surrounding ruins.

這座建築明顯**晚於**周圍的遺跡。

MCQ-ready definition:

postdate = 在時間上晚於另一件事物

24. **postdate a cheque/document — 把日期寫成未來日期**

Practice 1

> He **postdated the cheque** to next Friday.

他把支票日期**填成下星期五**。

Practice 2

> The payment document was **postdated**.

付款文件被**填上未來日期**。

MCQ-ready definition:

postdate something = 在文件上寫上一個晚於實際填寫日的日期

25. **undated — 沒有註明日期的**

Practice 1

> The letter was **undated**.

這封信**沒有註明日期**。

Practice 2

> Researchers found several **undated documents**.

研究人員發現數份**沒有標示日期的文件**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****undated = 沒有寫明日期的****

26. ****a date (浪漫約會) — 約會****

A completely separate major noun branch.

Practice 1

> They went on a ****date**** last night.

他們昨晚去****約會****。

Practice 2

> He asked her out on a ****date****.

他約她出去****約會****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****date = 兩個人為了建立或發展浪漫關係而安排的見面****

27. ****go on a date — 去約會****

Practice 1

> They ****went on a date**** after work.

他們下班後去****約會****。

Practice 2

> I've never ****been on a date**** there.

我從未在那裏****約會過****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****go on a date = 與有浪漫可能的人一起安排見面或外出****

28. ****have a date — 有約會****

Practice 1

> I **have a date** tonight.

我今晚**有約會**。

Practice 2

> She already **had a date**.

她已經**有約會安排**。

MCQ-ready definition:

have a date = 已安排與某人進行浪漫性質的見面

29. **your date** — 約會對象；陪同者

Practice 1

> Who's your **date** tonight?

你今晚的**約會對象**是誰？

Practice 2

> He arrived at the party with his **date**.

他和自己的**約會對象**一起到派對。

MCQ-ready definition:

someone's date = 陪某人參加約會或社交活動的人，通常帶有浪漫意味

30. **blind date** — 與未見過的人約會；相親式約會

Practice 1

> They met on a **blind date**.

他們在一次**相親式約會**中認識。

Practice 2

> My friend arranged a **blind date** for me.

朋友替我安排了一次**與陌生人約會**。

MCQ-ready definition:

blind date = 與之前未見過或不熟悉的人安排的浪漫約會

31. **double date — 兩對人一起約會**

Practice 1

> We went on a **double date**.

我們兩對人一起去**約會**。

Practice 2

> They invited us on a **double date**.

他們邀請我們來一次**兩對人的約會**。

MCQ-ready definition:

double date = 兩對約會中的人一起外出的活動

32. **date night — 情侶約會之夜**

A common modern compound.

Practice 1

> Friday is our **date night**.

星期五是我們固定的**情侶約會之夜**。

Practice 2

> They try to have a **date night** once a month.

他們盡量每月安排一次**二人約會時間**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****date night = 情侶特意預留時間一起外出或相處的晚上****

33. ****speed dating — 快速約會****

Practice 1

> They met at a ****speed-dating**** event.

他們在一次****快速約會活動****中認識。

Practice 2

> ****Speed dating**** lets people meet many potential partners quickly.

****快速約會****讓人短時間內認識多位潛在伴侶。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****speed dating = 與多名陌生人逐一作短時間交談，以尋找潛在約會對象的活動****

34. ****date someone — 與某人約會 / 交往****

Practice 1

> They ****dated**** for two years.

他們****拍拖 / 交往了兩年****。

Practice 2

> She is ****dating someone**** from work.

她正在和一名同事****約會 / 交往****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****date someone = 與某人建立或發展浪漫關係****

35. ****dating (約會 / 交往) — 約會 ; 拍拖****

Practice 1

> Online **dating** has become common.

網上**交友約會**已很普遍。

Practice 2

> They started **dating** last year.

他們去年開始**拍拖**。

MCQ-ready definition:

dating = 與人建立或探索浪漫關係的活動或階段

36. **date (椰棗) — 椰棗 ; 海棗果實**

This was the major missing bare-word sense.

It is a completely separate lexical branch from **date = 日期** and **date = 約會**.

Practice 1

> She added chopped **dates** to the cake.

她在蛋糕裏加入了切碎的**椰棗**。

Practice 2

> **Dates** are naturally very sweet.

椰棗天然非常甜。

MCQ-ready definition:

date = 海棗樹所結的甜味果實，通常呈啡色，可鮮食或乾製

37. **date palm — 海棗樹**

Practice 1

> **Date palms** grow well in hot, dry regions.

海棗樹很適合在炎熱乾燥地區生長。

Practice 2

> The farm grows hundreds of **date palms**.

這個農場種植了數百棵**海棗樹**。

MCQ-ready definition:

date palm = 結出椰棗的棕櫚科植物

38. **dried dates** — 乾椰棗

Practice 1

> We packed some **dried dates** for the trip.

我們帶了一些**乾椰棗**去旅行。

Practice 2

> **Dried dates** are often used in desserts.

乾椰棗常用於甜品。

MCQ-ready definition:

dried dates = 去除部分水分後保存的椰棗

39. **pitted dates** — 去核椰棗

Practice 1

> Use **pitted dates** for the recipe.

這個食譜請使用**去核椰棗**。

Practice 2

> She bought a bag of **pitted dates**.

她買了一袋**去核椰棗**。

MCQ-ready definition:

pitted dates = 已經除去果核的椰棗

40. **date syrup / date paste — 椰棗糖漿 / 椰棗蓉**

Practice 1

> The cake is sweetened with **date syrup**.

這個蛋糕用**椰棗糖漿**增加甜味。

Practice 2

> Mix the nuts with **date paste**.

把果仁和**椰棗蓉**混合。

MCQ-ready definition:

date syrup/paste = 以椰棗製成的糖漿或濃稠果蓉

41. **dated — 過時的；有年代感的**

Practice 1

> The design looks rather **dated** now.

這個設計現在看起來相當**過時**。

Practice 2

> Some of the language in the book feels **dated**.

書中的部分用語顯得很**有年代感 / 過時**。

MCQ-ready definition:

dated = 明顯帶有較早時期的風格，因此現在看起來不再現代或時髦

42. **outdated — 過時的；不再適用的**

Practice 1

> The software is **outdated**.

這個軟件已經**過時**。

Practice 2

> That teaching method is now considered **outdated**.

那種教學方法現在被視為**過時**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****outdated = 因有更新、更準確或更合適的事物取代而不再適用的****

Important distinction 1: **date vs day**

date

= calendar position.

day

= a 24-hour period or weekday.

> What's the **date**?

> 今天幾號？

> What **day** is it?

> 今天星期幾？

Important distinction 2: **date vs year**

A **date** can be exact:

> 8 May 1945

But in history teaching:

> names and dates

often includes important **years** such as 1914 or 1945.

So in your passage, translating **dates** as **「年份」** is very natural.

Important distinction 3: **date vs period / era**

date

specific time point.

period

stretch of time.

era

long historical age.

> date of the event

> 事件日期

> Victorian period

> 維多利亞時期

> modern era

> 現代時代

Important distinction 4: **date something vs date from**

date something

someone determines the object's age.

> Experts dated the object to 1800.

date from

the object originates then.

> The object dates from 1800.

Important distinction 5: **date back to vs predate**

date back to X

= originates in X.

> The tradition dates back to 1900.

predate X

= existed before X.

> The tradition predates television.

The first gives an origin point; the second makes a comparison.

Important distinction 6: **predate vs postdate**

predate

earlier than.

postdate

later than.

> The temple predates the road.

寺廟早於道路。

> The extension postdates the original building.

擴建部分晚於原建築。

Important distinction 7: **postdate = later than vs postdate a cheque**

Two senses:

historical

> The document postdates the war.

文件晚於戰爭。

documentary

> postdate a cheque

把支票日期寫成未來日子。

Important distinction 8: ****dated vs outdated****

****dated****

looks/feels old-fashioned.

****outdated****

no longer current or suitable.

> dated furniture

> 有年代感的家具

> outdated information

> 過時資料

Something can be dated aesthetically but still perfectly usable.

Important distinction 9: ****out of date vs outdated****

****out of date****

often:

* no longer current

* expired

****outdated****

often:

* superseded

* old-fashioned

* no longer appropriate

> an out-of-date passport

> 過期護照

> outdated technology

> 過時科技

Important distinction 10: **up to date vs current**

current

belongs to the present.

up to date

has been updated with the latest information.

> current policy

> 現行政策

> up-to-date information

> 最新資料

Important distinction 11: **date noun vs date verb**

Noun

> What's the **date**?

日期是甚麼？

Verb

> Please **date** the letter.

請在信上填上日期。

Important distinction 12: **date = calendar vs date = romance**

Completely different modern meanings.

> What's the **date**?

今天幾號？

> I have a **date** tonight.

我今晚有約會。

Important distinction 13: **date someone vs meet someone**

date someone

romantic involvement.

meet someone

simply encounter or spend time together.

You can meet someone many times without dating them.

Important distinction 14: **a date vs your date**

a date

the event:

> We went on a date.

我們去約會。

your date

the person:

> Who's your date?

你的約會對象是誰？

This is a genuine noun-sense shift.

Important distinction 15: **date vs relationship**

dating

can be early-stage romantic involvement.

relationship

usually suggests a more established relationship.

> We've been on three dates.

我們約會了三次。

does not automatically mean:

> We're in a relationship.

我們已正式拍拖。

Important distinction 16: **dating = romance vs dating = archaeology/science**

Romance

> online dating

網上約會

Scientific

> archaeological dating

考古年代測定

Same form, completely different domains.

Important distinction 17: **date fruit vs calendar date**

These are homonyms in modern English.

Calendar

> today's date

今天日期

Fruit

> eat a date

吃一顆椰棗

There is no useful modern semantic connection for learners, so they should be treated as separate lexical branches.

Important distinction 18: **date vs raisin / fig**

The fruit sense is also worth distinguishing.

date

椰棗

raisin

葡萄乾

fig

無花果

A **date** is not simply any dried fruit. Fresh dates also exist.

Important distinction 19: **dried date vs date**

A **date** fruit may be fresh, semi-dry, or dried.

So:

> date

= 椰棗 generally

> dried date

= specifically 乾椰棗

Important distinction 20: **date palm vs palm tree**

palm tree

broad category of 棕櫚類植物.

date palm

specific palm that produces dates.

So every date palm is a palm, but not every palm is a date palm.

Family-extension note

Date is a classic high-value polysemy word because it contains **three major modern lexical branches**:

1. **calendar / chronology**

- * date
- * date of birth
- * date something
- * date back to
- * dating
- * predate
- * postdate
- * dated
- * undated
- * up-to-date / out-of-date

2. **romance**

- * a date
- * your date
- * go on a date
- * date someone
- * dating
- * blind date
- * date night

3. **fruit**

- * a date
- * date palm
- * dried dates
- * pitted dates
- * date syrup

The **calendar** and **romance** branches are historically connected, but for modern learners they behave as distinct lexical meanings.

The **fruit sense** is a separate homonymous branch and must be taught separately.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
-----	-----	-----
date	日期	calendar point
historical date	歷史日期 / 年份	event time
today's date	今天日期	current calendar date
date of birth	出生日期	birth date
date of issue	簽發日期	issue date
effective date	生效日期	start of validity
closing date	截止日期	deadline
expiry date	到期日	end of validity
best-before date	最佳食用日期	food-quality date
set/fix a date	定日期	schedule
at a later date	日後	later time
to date	到目前為止	until now
up to date	最新的	current
out of date	過時 / 過期	no longer current
save the date	預留日期	reserve calendar day
date (era)	年代	historical period
date a document	註明日期	mark date
date an object	確定年代	establish age
dating	年代測定	determine age
carbon dating	碳年代測定	scientific dating
date from/back to	始於 / 追溯至	historical origin
predate	早於	earlier than
postdate	晚於	later than
postdate a cheque	填未來日期	future-date document
undated	未註日期的	no date shown
a date	約會	romantic meeting
go on a date	去約會	romantic outing
your date	約會對象	romantic companion

blind date	相親式約會	unknown partner	
double date	兩對一起約會	two couples	
date night	情侶約會之夜	planned couple time	
date someone	與某人交往	romantic relationship	
dating	約會；拍拖	romantic activity	
date (fruit)	椰棗	fruit	
date palm	海棗樹	fruit-producing palm	
dried dates	乾椰棗	dried fruit	
pitted dates	去核椰棗	stone removed	
date syrup	椰棗糖漿	date-based sweetener	
date paste	椰棗蓉	date-based paste	
dated	過時 / 有年代感	old-fashioned	
outdated	過時、不再適用	superseded	

For your original sentence

> He taught history, but he never treated it as a dry subject full of names and **dates**.

Here:

dates = 歷史事件的重要年份或日期

The phrase:

> **names and dates**

represents factual memorisation:

* **names** → 誰

* **dates** → 何時

Mr Chan did not stop at those facts; he turned history into human stories and encouraged students to ask **why** events happened.

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 他從不把歷史當成一門只有人名和**年份**的枯燥科目。

And yes — this revised version now includes the missing **date = 椰棗**, plus the family-sweep omissions **predate, postdate, undated, dating = 年代測定, at a later date, save the date, date night**, and the main practical date compounds.